Initial Post

Initial Post

by Ali Alzahmi - Tuesday, 13 May 2025, 8:46 AM

A positive example of ethical computing appears in the ACM's case study about Corazón, a medical technology startup. Corazón created implantable heart health monitoring devices that were quickly permitted by medical device regulation agencies worldwide (Association for Computing Machinery, n.d.). Being successful for Corazón means more than great technology; it requires keeping patient information safe and helping people in need get healthcare. Corazón's partnerships with charities allow them to supply low-income patients with free or reduced-cost devices, demonstrating responsibility to society and technical superiority (Birkett et al., 2023).

The ACM Code of Ethics supports helping people, guarding privacy, and acting honestly and with trustworthiness. Corazón proves these principles by ensuring that patient information is safe and business deals are moral. Accessibility is one way that Corazón responds to the ACM's encouragement for using digital tools to help society (BCS, 2022). Adhering to medical device rules worldwide adds to Corazón's status as a responsible organization. By sticking to rules like GDPR in Europe, Corazón proves they are serious about legal and ethical standards. Corazón reduces health inequality by offering sophisticated medical tools to people who cannot afford them. Doing so helps patients improve and gives people confidence in digital health systems (Yang et al., 2022). By being proactive, Corazón shows other tech firms that ethical conduct and making money can go hand in hand.

For example, the BCS Code of Conduct stresses working for the public's benefit, keeping skills up-to-date, and protecting citizens' privacy. Corazón achieves these requirements by ensuring patient information is safe and making healthcare fairer for everyone (Van Speybroeck et al., 2021). Both ACM and BCS require members to act honestly and benefit society, and these are the same values shown by Corazón's ethical approach to design, development, and distribution.

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Peer Response

by Fahad Abdallah - Friday, 16 May 2025, 6:42 PM

Ali, you did a great job providing a positive and wise case study of Corazón. Your effort successfully identifies how ethical computing should not only be excellence in technology but can also respond to patient safety and social responsibility. I especially like your reference to Corazón's involvement with charities that offer free or low-cost implants to low-income individuals. This move shows how a business can combine technological innovation with social impact, which is something other tech companies should consider (Regalado, 2024).

The structure of your interpretation of the ACM Code of Ethics is perfect, illustrated by proper examples. Corazón's action conforms to ACM's principles of taking a positive approach to society, doing no harm, and not violating privacy (Birkett et al., 2023). You also clearly highlight their adherence to regulatory standards, such as the GDPR, which supports their legal and ethical position. Baltazar-Sabbah (2025) further supports your argument, explaining that the availability of advanced medical technologies to underprivileged groups promotes trust in digital health solutions. This is particularly important, as trust remains a significant factor in patient acceptance of connected healthcare technologies.

Your mention of the BCS Code of Conduct was also valuable to me. You rightfully explain how Corazón complies with the standards set by the BCS regarding the prioritization of public benefit, professional competence, and data protection (Lescrauwaet et al., 2022). Further, Voegtlin et al. (2022) reinforce this notion by demonstrating how medical technology can harmonize technical performance with safety and ethical responsibility. Patient risks are minimized through the use of proactive design and rigorous testing in their research.

On the whole, your post presents a balanced and optimistic view of the role that ethical computing can play in both business success and social benefit. It serves as a good reminder that any responsible innovation is not just about meeting technical specifications, but also about living up to moral ideals and the general public good. Well done.

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Re: Initial Post

by Ali Yousef Ebrahim Mohammed Alshehhi - Monday, 19 May 2025, 8:52 PM

Thank you Ali for the insightful and inspiring example of ethical computing in practice. Your discussion of Corazón demonstrates what advanced technology can be made to serve the public good when guided by ethics and social responsibility. The company's approach—especially its unification of equitable access and data protection—is exemplary of how the pursuit of profit and purpose can coexist in digital health.

I especially appreciate your emphasis on Corazón's compliance with global regulations like the GDPR and its alignment with ACM principles, particularly 1.1 (Contribute to society), 1.6 (Respect privacy), and 2.7 (Improve public understanding of computing). These elements show that responsible computing requires more than technical excellence—it requires foresight, integrity, and compassion (ACM, 2018).

As Floridi (2021) points out, ethical innovation in AI and health tech must be human-centered and designed with accountability built in from the start.

You also drew a meaningful parallel to the BCS Code of Conduct, which reinforces public interest and ethica[illegible] Chat to us! [illegible]d like to include that Corazón's openness and collaboration with charities promote not just their brand but also the public's trust,

which is crucial for the embrace of digital health solutions (Sharon, 2020).
In an industry where many companies prioritize speed to market, the approach of Corazón shows that forward-looking ethics and adherence to law can be compatible with innovation. Your case study is an excellent example of how computing professionals can both exercise technological leadership and ethical stewardship.

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Re: Initial Post

by Nasser Al-Naimi - Tuesday, 20 May 2025, 4:15 PM

Dear Ali, your analysis highlights how complying with standards such as ACM and GDPR can help build trust in digital health. However, a closer review uncovers limitations in measuring the full ethicality of a platform based entirely on its compliance with laws and regulations. Partnering with charities and complying with GDPR is a positive step, but ethical computing means going beyond adhering to rules to tackle root causes and potential adverse effects (Conley and Pocs, 2018). However, GDPR prioritises data privacy but does not guarantee fair and universal healthcare (Marelli, Lievevrouw, and Van Hoyweghen, 2020). While Corazón's charity initiatives are commendable, they could unintentionally promote the reliance on corporate generosity instead of addressing fundamental issues with the healthcare system.

Nevertheless, the benefits of Corazón's devices are accompanied by challenges like algorithmic bias and potential cybersecurity breaches (Ruotsalainen and Blobel, 2020). The lack of public knowledge about how Corazón creates and tests its algorithms undermines the credibility of its boasts about having the best technology. This claim that profit and ethics are compatible requires careful examination. Companies tend to favour maximising profits for investors. If a corporation's social activities are not integrated into its management, this may be a mere "ethics washing" (Maher, Khan, and Prikshat, 2023). Examining how power operates within an organisation is necessary to assess claims of ethical computing with greater rigour. You provide helpful insight into how ethics are discussed in the context of Big Tech companies. However, to critique Corazón more effectively, it is essential to analyse its broader social and corporate structures.

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Re: Initial Post

by Radha Murugan - Monday, 26 May 2025, 11:14 PM

The discussion points you have mentioned are very valuable on the case study of Corazón. The emphasis on ethical computing in patient safety and social responsibility is a key point.

The case study provides an excellent ethical learning opportunity, however it exposes the systemic flaws in corporate ethics and need for stronger safeguards to support ethical engineering. The discussion also highlights how it supports legal and ethical position.

The importance of risk communication section 1.2, should have been highlighted more as to explain how high impact defect is not an acceptable risk and what could have prevented potential injury. An incident in Jan 2010 temporarily closed VA catheterization laboratory in New Jersey temporarily closed, due to system issues reflects how patients felt when safe and effective care is impacting their life (Fu and Blum, 2013). Some of the references also insists on importance to recognize that the security is not equal to compliance with regulation as compliance are principles and security to address dynamic and uncertain environments (Williams and Woodward, 2015).

Although the case study encourages ethical thinking in medical software decisions, the discussion should also highlight section 1.3 about violating ethical duties of honesty by having lack of openness about the risks to regulatory bodies and end users.

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